

Termination of Resuscitation

There are many instances in which it is appropriate and reasonable to terminate resuscitation in the field. This is prudent in certain situations in which resuscitation efforts have been unsuccessful, and further efforts would be futile.

Non-traumatic cardiac arrest patients who meet **all** of the following criteria may be considered for field termination:

1. Has not been in a “shockable” rhythm (v-fib or v-tach) for more than one round of medication and defibrillation
2. Is in asystole or PEA
3. Has a blood glucose over 60
 - a. This may be after EMS personnel have administered Dextrose for hypoglycemia and rechecked the blood glucose to ensure it has improved
4. Has an established advanced airway (ETT or SGA) with an End-Tidal CO₂ reading
 - a. There are very few reasons that a patient has no end-tidal or an end-tidal of 1.
 - b. If a patient is intubated or has an SGA in place, and no end-tidal CO₂ reading or waveform, the equipment should be checked.
 - c. If this still does not reveal an end-tidal CO₂ reading or good waveform, the tube should be immediately pulled and the patient should be re-intubated.
5. Has had at least 20 minutes of advanced life support (ALS) resuscitative efforts
6. Preferably not in a public place
 - a. It is preferable not to terminate resuscitation on patients in a public place. If EMS personnel feel strongly that a patient resuscitation should be terminated in these circumstances, considerations should be given to moving the patient to the ambulance before calling the Medical Control physician or Medical Director
 - b. The scene with coworkers should not be considered “public”. Termination of resuscitation on scene in an austere environment with friends/family/coworkers surrounding them may be appropriate for the patient as well as the bystanders.

ANY Patient in cardiac arrest can be considered for termination in an austere environment at any time for the following reasons:

1. **The patient remains in cardiac arrest after 30 minutes of attempted resuscitation.**
2. **Resources are exhausted**

- 3. The scene becomes unsafe for medical and rescue personnel**
- 4. Advanced care and transport unit arrives to assist, and the patient meets their criteria for termination**

All field terminations require authorization by the Medical Control physician or Medical Director. If cell service or satellite service is not available, a call should be made as soon as possible after termination.